

EE3621: Digital Signal Processing

Lecture 15: Digital Filter Realization Basics — FIR Direct & Cascade Forms (III B.Tech EEE)

September 9, 2026

1. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

1. **Draw** Direct Form and Transposed Direct Form signal flow graphs for arbitrary FIR transfer functions.
 2. **Apply** the Flow Graph Reversal Theorem to transpose digital filter networks.
 3. **Factor** high-order FIR transfer functions into cascade second-order sections.
 4. **Compare** Direct and Cascade realizations in terms of multiplier count, memory delays, and coefficient sensitivity.
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2. MATHEMATICAL FOUNDATIONS

2.1 FIR Transfer Function & Direct Form

An FIR filter of length M (order $N = M - 1$) is described by:

$$y[n] = \sum_{k=0}^{M-1} b_k x[n-k] = b_0 x[n] + b_1 x[n-1] + \cdots + b_{M-1} x[n-M+1]$$

$$H(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{M-1} b_k z^{-k} = b_0 + b_1 z^{-1} + b_2 z^{-2} + \cdots + b_{M-1} z^{-(M-1)}$$

- **Direct Form Structure:** Consists of a tapped delay line of $M - 1$ registers, M parallel multiplier branches feeding a multi-input summation bus.

2.2 Transposed Direct Form (Flow Graph Reversal)

By the Flow Graph Reversal Theorem (Tellegen's Theorem for linear networks):

1. Reverse the direction of all signal branches.
2. Summing nodes become branching nodes; Branching nodes become summing nodes.

3. Interchange the input $x[n]$ and output $y[n]$.

The state equations for the Transposed Direct Form are:

$$\begin{aligned} y[n] &= b_0 x[n] + v_1[n-1] \\ v_k[n] &= b_k x[n] + v_{k+1}[n-1], \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, M-2 \\ v_{M-1}[n] &= b_{M-1} x[n] \end{aligned}$$

- **Engineering Advantage:** The input $x[n]$ is broadcast simultaneously to all multipliers. Adders are distributed between delay registers, eliminating the long critical-path adder tree of the standard direct form and facilitating high-speed pipelining.

2.3 Cascade Realization

Factoring $H(z)$ into a product of second-order real polynomials:

$$H(z) = b_0 \prod_{k=1}^K (1 + \beta_{1k} z^{-1} + \beta_{2k} z^{-2}), \quad K = \lfloor M/2 \rfloor$$

Each second-order section realizes a pair of complex conjugate zeros (z_k, z_k^*) :

$$1 + \beta_{1k} z^{-1} + \beta_{2k} z^{-2} = (1 - z_k z^{-1})(1 - z_k^* z^{-1})$$

Where $\beta_{1k} = -2\text{Re}(z_k)$ and $\beta_{2k} = |z_k|^2$.

Pictorial Representations

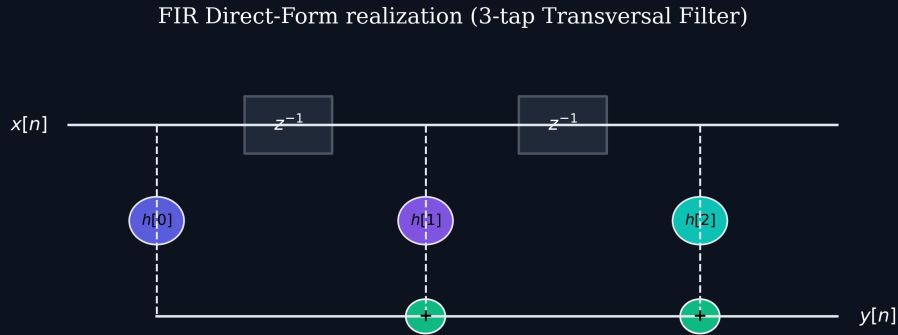


Figure 1: Fir Direct Form

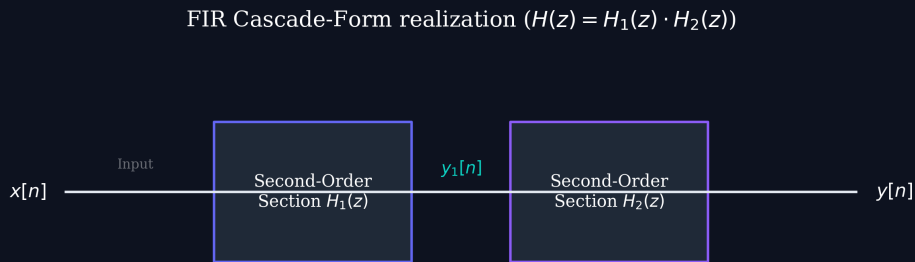


Figure 2: Fir Cascade Form

3. WORKED NUMERICAL EXAMPLES

Example 15.1: Direct and Cascade Realization of a 4th-Order FIR Filter

Problem: Realize the FIR filter given by transfer function:

$$H(z) = 1 + 2.5z^{-1} + 2.5z^{-2} + 1.25z^{-3} + 0.25z^{-4}$$

in (a) Direct Form, (b) Transposed Direct Form, and (c) Cascade Form.

Solution: (a) Direct Form: $y[n] = x[n] + 2.5x[n-1] + 2.5x[n-2] + 1.25x[n-3] + 0.25x[n-4]$. Requires 4 delay elements z^{-1} , 5 multipliers (or 4 non-trivial), and 4 two-input adders.

(b) Transposed Direct Form: $y[n] = x[n] + v_1[n-1]$ $v_1[n] = 2.5x[n] + v_2[n-1]$ $v_2[n] = 2.5x[n] + v_3[n-1]$ $v_3[n] = 1.25x[n] + v_4[n-1]$ $v_4[n] = 0.25x[n]$.

(c) Cascade Form: Factor $H(z)$ into two 2nd-order sections:

$$H(z) = (1 + 1.5z^{-1} + 0.5z^{-2})(1 + 1.0z^{-1} + 0.5z^{-2})$$

- Section 1: $H_1(z) = 1 + 1.5z^{-1} + 0.5z^{-2}$ (zeros at $z = -0.5, -1.0$)
- Section 2: $H_2(z) = 1 + 1.0z^{-1} + 0.5z^{-2}$ (zeros at $z = -0.5 \pm j0.5$)

The system is realized as the direct cascade of $H_1(z)$ followed by $H_2(z)$.

4. UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION QUESTIONS & MARKING RUBRIC

Question 1 (15 Marks)

(a) State the Flow Graph Reversal Theorem and explain how it is used to derive the Transposed Direct Form FIR structure. *(6 Marks)* **(b)** Realize the linear-phase FIR filter $H(z) = 1 - \frac{1}{2}z^{-1} + \frac{3}{2}z^{-2} - \frac{1}{2}z^{-3} + z^{-4}$ in Cascade Form using real second-order sections. Draw the complete SFG. *(9 Marks)*

Model Answer & Step-by-Step Marking Rubric:

- **Part (a):**

* Flow Graph Reversal Theorem rules (reversing branches, swapping nodes, swapping I/O) *(3 Marks)*
* Derivation of state equations and explanation of critical path pipelining advantage *(3 Marks)*

- **Part (b):**

* Factor $H(z)$ by finding roots or grouping quadratic factors: $H(z) = (1 - z^{-1} + z^{-2})(1 + 0.5z^{-1} + z^{-2}) = 1 - 0.5z^{-1} + 1.5z^{-2} - 0.5z^{-3} + z^{-4}$ *(4 Marks)*
* Section 1: $H_1(z) = 1 - z^{-1} + z^{-2}$
* Section 2: $H_2(z) = 1 + 0.5z^{-1} + z^{-2}$ *(2 Marks)*
* Neatly drawn SFG showing cascade interconnection with labeled branch gains and unit delays *(3 Marks)*

5. PYTHON VERIFICATION SCRIPT

```
import numpy as np
import scipy.signal as signal

b = [1.0, 2.5, 2.5, 1.25, 0.25]
sos = signal.tf2sos(b, [1.0])
print("Cascade SOS Sections:")
print(sos)
```